



Slax 6

Slacks Off To You!

Slax Graphics mode (XBE)

Slax Always Fresh

Slax Copy To RAM

Slax Graphics UESA mode

Slax Text mode

Slax as PXE server

Run Mntest utility

More about currently selected:

Slax the best way we can.

Slax will autoconfigure graphics

Slax will use the maximum

Slax will resolution

Automatic boot in 7 seconds...

First, there was Slackware. And then there was Slax. As the similarity between the names suggests, Slax is actually a size-optimised (well, from 1.9 GB worth of installation files to a 190.1MB LiveCD) version of Slackware that's meant for use as a Live CD and LiveUSB.

*W*e have seen smaller Live distros than Slax (SliTaz, for instance), but Slax is by far the most famous and proven Live distro. Slax, though not at all officially related to Slackware, rigorously follows the Slackware release cycle. The subject of our review, version 6.0.9, was released on the same day as Slackware 12.2 (December 10, 2008). Built from Slackware 12.2, it has the same rock solid stability and simplicity, while maintaining the ease of use not found in its upstream versions.

Slax 5 to 6

Those who are still using Slax version 5 will find a lot of differences between Slax 5 and 6. These are:

1. Most importantly, version 6 is available in only one edition. Slax

- 5 had Standard, KillBill (Microsoft Killer), Foro, Popcorn and Server editions. Slax 6 has none of the KillBill or Server features; they need additional modules to be downloaded.
2. This brings us to modules. Previously, the Slax base was not a module, while anything running on top of it, was (such as X11). Now, everything is a module, even the base. Slax 6 comes with 6 modules—core, xorg, kde, kdeapps, devel and koffice. You can remove or replace these base components if you wish.
3. X starts automatically! There's no need to run *xconf* and *startx*. The downside of this is that you run in X as the root.
4. The Slax bootsplash flower has been done away with—there's only boring text now.